Diabetes-Friendly Food List

A general food list — what to eat, what to eat in moderation, what to avoid — Free preview

When you live with diabetes, many questions come up about food — what can be eaten, what should be eaten less, and what is better to avoid. This guide gives a general answer to those questions, using the familiar foods of our homes. It is not medical advice, but general information.

The main framework of this guide is the Diabetes Plate Method — a simple visual approach in which half the plate is filled with non-starchy vegetables, one quarter with protein, and one quarter with carbohydrate foods. Water is kept on the side. Nothing needs to be weighed or counted.

What is it?

The foods in the list are divided into three groups: foods often chosen, foods best eaten in moderation, and foods better avoided. These groups are general ideas — every person's body, medication and daily routine is different, so the same list does not apply equally to everyone.

It works best to fit the list into the family's ordinary food — instead of cooking separate special food, build your own plate from the same pot the family eats from. That makes eating easier, and lets you share meals with the family.

How to start — a glimpse

1. First, remember the Diabetes Plate Method: half the plate non-starchy vegetables, one quarter protein, one quarter carbohydrate foods.
2. At each main meal, try to fill half the plate with non-starchy vegetables — bottle gourd, spinach, red amaranth, cauliflower, eggplant, okra, cucumber, tomato — whatever is in season.

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